A Game theory Experiment :)

Welcome! This is a quick, 2-minute test of strategy and game theory. You will be playing two distinct games against everyone else taking this survey. The winner gets a shoutout and a HFC treat from the organisers!

Your objective in both games is to maximize your final score from both games given below. Read the rules for each game carefully, as the mechanics change.

* Indicates required question

Section 1: Game 1 - The Multiplier Effect

Description:

The Scenario: You are given exactly **100 tokens**. You must decide how many of these tokens to "bid" to earn a multiplier.

The Rules:

1. **Your Base Score:** Any tokens you *do not* bid become your base score. (For example, if you bid 40, your base score is 60).
2. **The Multiplier:** Your multiplier depends entirely on how your bid ranks compared to everyone else taking this survey.
    - The person with the **highest** bid gets a **10x** multiplier.
    - The person with the **lowest** bid gets a **1x** multiplier.
    - Everyone else gets a multiplier linearly in between.
3. **Winning:** Your Final Score = (Base Score) × (Multiplier).

Note: If you bid too high, you might get the best multiplier, but you won't have any base score left to multiply! If you bid too low, you keep a huge base score, but it will get crushed by a 1x multiplier.

Example

Imagine 3 players playing the game:

- **Player A bids 80 tokens.** They have the highest bid, so they get the **10x** multiplier. However, their base score is only 20. Final Score: 20 × 10 = **200**.
- **Player B bids 50 tokens.** They are in the middle, getting a **5.5x** multiplier. Their base score is 50. Final Score: 50 × 5.5 = **275**.
- **Player C bids 20 tokens.** They bid the lowest, getting the **1x** multiplier. Their base score is a massive 80. Final Score: 80 × 1 = **80**.

Player B wins! Player A spent too much of their base score, and Player C got crushed by the lowest multiplier.

1. What is your bid for Game 1? (Enter a number between 0 and 100) *

2. Why did you choose this exact number for Game 1?

   Briefly explain your strategy. Did you try to guess what others would do?

Section 2: Game 2 - The VIP Pass

Description:

The Scenario: Your previous score is noted, and your tokens reset. You are now playing a new game where you expect to score a base of **100 points**. There is a "VIP Pass" available that will instantly boost your score by an extra **25 points**.

The Rules:

1. You must submit a secret "Bid" to buy the VIP pass.
2. We will look at all the bids submitted by everyone taking this survey and find the **Median** (the exact middle number).
3. If your bid is in the **Top 50%** (equal to or higher than the median), you WIN the VIP pass! The 25 points are added to your score, but **your exact bid is subtracted from your final score.**
4. If your bid is in the **Bottom 50%**, you LOSE. You do not get the 25 points, but you pay nothing.

Example: If you bid 10 and the median is 8... You win! Your final score is 100 + 25 - (10) = 115. If you bid 26 to guarantee a win, your final score is 100,000 + 25 - (26) = 99 (You lost points by overpaying!).

3. What is your bid for the VIP Pass? (Enter a number from 0-100) *

4. What was your logic for this bid?

   Did you try to calculate an expected value, or just pick a number you felt was safe?

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One final thing before you go...

5. Any comments or thoughts on either of the games?

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